Texas Tech University Dissertation Template

by

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Dean of the Graduate School

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ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

This template is the direct result of procrastinating the writing of my own dissertation, which will be defended three weeks from the creation of this repository. I was dissapointed to find no template for LaTeX officially supported by the graduate school, and sought to automate the process of formatting to the greatest extent feasible.

As I compile the summation of my education at Texas Tech University, I reflect on the cherished memories that I made here and how much I will miss it when I move on. Writing a thesis is no easy feat, and if the reader is in a similar state of mind as I am at the moment, I encourage them to keep their head up. You are almost at the finish line, and you will one day look back at this document with pride. I hope that I have alleviated at least some stress from the terminal weeks of your degree.

Wreck ’em Tech!

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ABSTRACT

This document is a template rather than a thesis, and this section stands in for the abstract you will write. Replace it with a summary of the problem you addressed, the approach you took, and what you found. An abstract is read by people deciding whether to read anything else, so it should be intelligible on its own and should not depend on the reader already knowing the field.

State the principal results plainly and quantitatively where you can. Avoid promising that results "will be discussed"; say what they were. Two or three paragraphs is the expected length, and the Graduate School asks for no subheadings and no citations here, which means any claim that would ordinarily need a reference has to be phrased as your own finding or left out.

Close with what the results mean for the field: the one sentence a reader should retain if they read nothing further.

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

TTU	Texas Tech University
WET	Wreck ’em Tech
RR	Raider Red
MR	Masked Rider

CHAPTER I
INTRODUCTION

This chapter is a working example of every element the template supports. Each element is preceded by a one-line `% HOW TO:` comment in the source file, so the pattern can be copied without first learning the machinery behind it. Delete the whole file once your own first chapter is written; nothing else depends on it.

Write ordinary paragraphs like this one. The class takes care of margins, line spacing, the running header and the page number, and it applies the Graduate School's rules whether or not you remember them. Nothing in this file sets a length, a font size, or a spacing command, and nothing in your own chapters needs to either. If you find yourself reaching for a spacing command, the formatting is probably already correct and the instinct is worth resisting.

The one habit the template cannot supply is order. Introduce a figure or a table in the text before it appears, keep the numbering in the order you mention things, and let the class place them.

1.1 First-level Subheadings

A first-level subheading opens a major division of the chapter. The heading levels below it are styled distinctly from one another, so a reader can tell depth by eye as well as by number, and they are tagged as a real heading hierarchy so that a screen reader can navigate between them.

Levels should be used in order, without skipping. A subsection inside a chapter with no intervening section is legal LaTeX and a genuine accessibility defect, because it leaves a gap in the outline that assistive technology reports as a structural error.

1.1.1 Second-level subheadings

Text under a second-level subheading. Most chapters will not need more than three levels; the remaining two exist for the occasions that do, and are shown here so that their appearance is known in advance rather than discovered during a formatting review.

Third-level subheadings

Third-level subheadings are unnumbered by default, on the view that a four-part decimal number is harder to read than the words it precedes. If your committee wants them numbered, that is a one-line change in the class.

Fourth-level subheadings

Fourth-level subheadings are set in the body face, distinguished only by the space around them. They mark a turn in the argument rather than a new topic.

Fifth-level subheadings. Please do not use fifth level subheadings. Fourth is probably excessive too. This is not a rule of the graduate school, but everyone will think you are a goober. If absolutely necessary, the fifth level runs into the paragraph it introduces, which is the conventional way to label a definition or an aside without spending a whole line on it. Anything finer than this is better handled with a list or a plain sentence.

1.2 Lists

Lists are tagged as real lists, so the number of items and the boundary between them are announced correctly. Use them for genuinely parallel material, not to break up prose:

- an unnumbered item, for things with no inherent order,
- and a second unnumbered item.

Numbered lists carry the additional claim that the order matters, which is worth honouring:

1. A numbered item.
2. A second numbered item.

1.3 Figures, Tables and Equations

1.3.1 Figures

Figure 1.1 is the worked example. The caption is set flush left and single-spaced, and the alt text in the source describes what the image shows, which is not the same information the caption carries. A caption names the figure for everyone; alt text describes it for a reader who cannot see it. Writing one and calling it the other is the most common way an otherwise careful document fails an accessibility check.

Alt text of one or two sentences is what the manual asks for. Describe the content and what it demonstrates, not the file it came from: *a line rising steeply and then flattening* is useful, *a graph* is not.

An image that carries no information at all is marked differently. The ornament below is included with the `artifact` key instead of `alt`, which removes it from the reading order entirely. The test is simple: if the image vanished and the reader lost nothing, it is an artifact; if they lost something, it needs alt text.

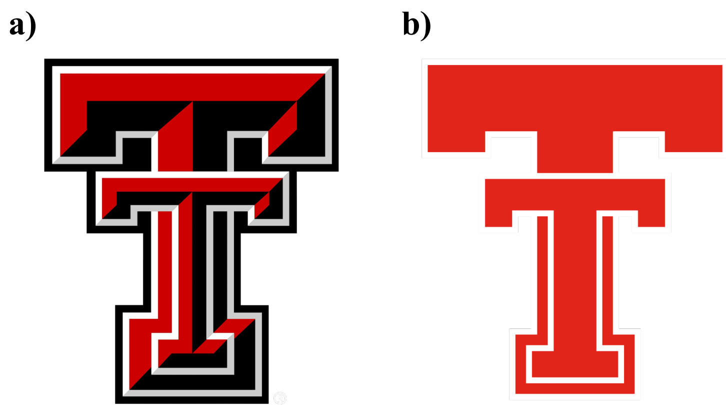

Figure 1.1. Comparison of the current (a) and retro (b) Texas Tech University Double-T logos.

1.3.2 Tables

Table 1.1 lists the nominal operating conditions used throughout this example. Build tables as real tables, never as screenshots: a picture of a table cannot be read aloud, navigated by column, searched, or corrected. The first row is tagged as the header row for you, which is what allows a screen reader to announce a cell as *Pressure, kilopascals: 100* rather than simply *100*.

Table 1.1. Nominal operating conditions for the three test cases.

Case	Pressure (kPa)	Temperature (K)
Low	50	300
Medium	100	450
High	200	600

Table 1.2 runs past the bottom of the page. A long table repeats its header row on each new page and is labelled "Continued" after the first, so a reader arriving mid-table still knows what the columns mean. Long tables do not float: they are set exactly where they appear in the source, which is why the introducing sentence has to come first.

Table 1.2. Extended parameter sweep spanning more than one page.

Run	Setting	Result
R01	1.0	0.11
R02	1.1	0.14

Table 1.2. Continued.

Run	Setting	Result
R03	1.2	0.17
R04	1.3	0.21
R05	1.4	0.25
R06	1.5	0.29
R07	1.6	0.34
R08	1.7	0.39
R09	1.8	0.44
R10	1.9	0.50
R11	2.0	0.56
R12	2.1	0.62
R13	2.2	0.68
R14	2.3	0.75
R15	2.4	0.82
R16	2.5	0.89
R17	2.6	0.96
R18	2.7	1.04
R19	2.8	1.12
R20	2.9	1.20
R21	3.0	1.29
R22	3.1	1.38
R23	3.2	1.47
R24	3.3	1.56
R25	3.4	1.66
R26	3.5	1.76
R27	3.6	1.86
R28	3.7	1.97
R29	3.8	2.08
R30	3.9	2.19
R31	4.0	2.31
R32	4.1	2.43
R33	4.2	2.55
R34	4.3	2.67
R35	4.4	2.80

Table 1.2. Continued.

Run	Setting	Result
R36	4.5	2.93
R37	4.6	3.06
R38	4.7	3.20
R39	4.8	3.34
R40	4.9	3.48
R41	5.0	3.63
R42	5.1	3.78

1.3.3 Equations

Display equations are numbered at the right margin and are exported as MathML, which means assistive technology can navigate into a fraction or read a subscript as a subscript rather than reciting the symbols in a row. No alt text is written for equations in this template. The saturating behaviour discussed above is described by

$$y = \frac{ax}{b + x}, \tag{1.1}$$

where a is the asymptotic value and b the half-saturation constant. Refer to a numbered equation as Equation (1.1) rather than as "the equation above", which stops being true as soon as a page break moves.

1.4 Citations and Links

The bibliography is generated from `bibliography/references.bib` by biber, and citations are numbered in order of first appearance. A reader struggling to begin the writing itself may take some encouragement from the concision of earlier contributions to the literature [1], which are inexplicably peer-reviewed. For a more conventional demonstration, the method follows established practice [2] and the underlying theory is set out in a standard text [3].

Journal names print in full by default. Setting `journal-abbreviations = {true}` in the configuration file switches every entry that carries a `shortjournal` field to its abbreviated form, leaving entries without one untouched.

Link text has to say where it goes. Write the address, or a phrase that describes the destination; a document whose links all read "click here" is unusable for anyone who navigates by pulling up a list of them. The Graduate School's requirements are published at https://www.depts.ttu.edu/gradschool/.

BIBLIOGRAPHY

[1] D. Upper, “The unsuccessful self-treatment of a case of “writer’s block”,” *Journal of Applied Behavior Analysis*, vol. 7, no. 3, p. 497, 1974.

[2] F. A. Author and S. B. Coauthor, “A representative journal article used as a citation example,” *Journal of Example Studies*, vol. 12, no. 3, pp. 101–115, 2024.

[3] T. C. Writer, *A Representative Textbook*, 2nd ed. Lubbock, TX: Example University Press, 2021.

APPENDIX A
SUPPLEMENTARY MATERIAL

Supporting material that would interrupt the argument belongs here rather than in the body: extended derivations, full instrument settings, code listings, questionnaire text, or the signed AI Use Agreement if one is required. An appendix is read by the few people who need it, so completeness matters more than concision.

Each appendix is a separate file with its own `\chapter` command and its own `\input` line in `main.tex`, exactly like a chapter. The `\ThesisAppendices` line above those inputs is all the setup there is: two or more appendix files are lettered A, B, C, with their tables and figures numbered A.1, B.1 and so on, while a single appendix file prints an unlettered "APPENDIX" and numbers its tables and figures 1, 2, 3.

A.1 An Appendix Subheading

Appendix subheadings are styled like the ones in a chapter but are left out of the table of contents, which lists appendix titles only. Tables and figures inside an appendix carry the appendix letter, where there is one, and are listed in the List of Tables and the List of Figures either way, so a reader scanning those lists can find them without knowing they are in an appendix.

Table A.1. Instrument settings used throughout the study.

Setting	Value
Sampling rate (Hz)	1000
Gain	10

a) **b)**

Figure A.1. Demonstrating multiple appendecies with the Double T logos.

APPENDIX B
SUPPLEMENTARY MATERIAL

Supporting material that would interrupt the argument belongs here rather than in the body: extended derivations, full instrument settings, code listings, questionnaire text, or the signed AI Use Agreement if one is required. An appendix is read by the few people who need it, so completeness matters more than concision.

Each appendix is a separate file with its own `\chapter` command and its own `\input` line in `main.tex`, exactly like a chapter. The `\ThesisAppendices` line above those inputs is all the setup there is: two or more appendix files are lettered A, B, C, with their tables and figures numbered A.1, B.1 and so on, while a single appendix file prints an unlettered "APPENDIX" and numbers its tables and figures 1, 2, 3.

B.1 An Appendix Subheading

Appendix subheadings are styled like the ones in a chapter but are left out of the table of contents, which lists appendix titles only. Tables and figures inside an appendix carry the appendix letter, where there is one, and are listed in the List of Tables and the List of Figures either way, so a reader scanning those lists can find them without knowing they are in an appendix.

Table B.1. Instrument settings used throughout the study.

Setting	Value
Sampling rate (Hz)	1000
Gain	10

a) **b)**

Figure B.1. Demonstrating multiple appendecies with the Double T logos.